

Disclaimer: Drama TEI-XML

In general, the Middle English Texts Series strives to follow guidelines published by the Textual Encoding Initiative (TEI) when preparing XML files for our texts and editions. When preparing Drama texts, however, preserving the publication's visual formatting sometimes requires that we deviate from TEI-XML guidelines.

Drama utilizes <sp> (speech) elements in lieu of line group elements or anonymous block elements. Typically, every <sp> element in TEI-XML contains a nested <speaker> element. The <speaker> identifies the party currently speaking. For example, see the following passage from Theresa Coletti's edition of *The Digby Mary Magdalene Play*:

```
<sp>
  <speaker>
    <foreign xml:lang="lat">Nuncyus</foreign>
  </speaker>
</>
<space rend="indent1"/>
Farewell, my lord of grett renown,
<note type="tnote-indicator" n="333">T</note>
</l>
</>
<milestone n="1335" unit="line"/>
<space rend="indent1"/>
For owt of town my way I take.
</l>
</sp>
```

The <sp> element identifies this passage as speech delivered by Nuncyus, as seen by the <speaker> element. Whenever possible, METS adheres to this format, which mirrors the layout of our print editions.

A problem arises when a <speaker> delivers two or more stanzas of dialogue. In these instances, the first stanza appears as expected. The second stanza, however, contains a <sp> element *without* a nested <speaker>. For example, see the following passage from Coletti's edition:

programs, however, the presence of a <sp> element without a nested <speaker> can introduce some confusion and potentially alter data output.

As such, we recommend that users performing programmatic data analysis on METS Drama texts either **(a)** download and reconfigure our XML, inserting any <speaker> elements needed for clarity, or **(b)** configure their data analysis software to assume that any <sp> elements without a <speaker> utilize the same <speaker> as the last <sp> element that contains a <speaker> element.